

Welcome Back!

There Is / There Are

English Básico A1 · Beginner 1 · Unit 4

- Thursday, August 6, 2026 · Day 16
- The main grammar of Unit 4

Warm-Up!

Let's remember yesterday

1

What day is it today? Answer in a full sentence.

2

How much ARE these shoes? (it's / they're)

3

My birthday is ____ August. The store opens ____ 9:00 ____ Monday. (in/at/on)

Today's Agenda

There Is / There Are — the main grammar of Unit 4

- 01 What Is There Is/There Are?
- 02 Affirmative
- 03 Negative
- 04 Questions & Short Answers
- 05 When to Use Each: There Is/Are vs. To Be vs. Have
- 06 Practice + Notice It! (a real street)
- 07 Riddle Time!

Platform reminder: Unit 4 is due Saturday.

SECTION 1

What Is There Is/There Are?

Describing what EXISTS in a place.

What Is There Is / There Are?

Definition

These two structures describe what EXISTS in a place — in Spanish, you'd say 'hay': hay una tienda, hay dos tiendas.

THERE IS

hay UNO — one thing. Singular.

THERE ARE

hay MÁS DE UNO — more than one. Plural.

The Logic — la lógica

This is the EXACT same rule as "to be": I AM, she IS, they ARE. IS goes with singular nouns. ARE goes with plural nouns. THERE IS for one, THERE ARE for more than one — you already know this pattern!

Examples: There Is vs. There Are

Seeing singular and plural side by side:

Singular

There is a bookstore near my house.

Plural

There are two bookstores in my city.

Singular

There is a cat in the kitchen.

Plural

There are three cats in the kitchen.

Singular

There is one student absent today.

SECTION 2

Affirmative

There is a... / There are...

There Is / There Are: Affirmative

THERE IS + singular noun

- There is a bookstore near my house.
- There is a shoe store on Main Street.
- There is a supermarket downtown.

Also use "a/an" with the singular noun — same rule as always.

THERE ARE + plural noun

- There are two bookstores in my city.
- There are many stores on this street.
- There are three shoe stores downtown.

No "a/an" here — plural nouns don't take an article.

Examples: Affirmative in Context

Different situations, singular and plural:

At home

There is a big kitchen in my apartment.

In the city

There are many restaurants downtown.

At school

There is a library on the second floor.

In the fridge

There are some eggs and a little milk.

In the neighborhood

There are two supermarkets near my house.

SECTION 3

Negative

There isn't a... / There aren't any...

There Isn't / There Aren't: Negative

THERE ISN'T (there is not)

Hay uno, pero no existe.

- There isn't a clothing store here.
- There isn't a furniture store nearby.

THERE AREN'T (there are not)

Hay más, pero no existen.

- There aren't any supermarkets nearby.
- There aren't many clothing stores.

⚠ ANY appears here — remember from Unit 3?

Just like 'I don't have ANY bread,' negative sentences with THERE ARE often use ANY: 'There aren't ANY supermarkets nearby.' Same rule — SOME for affirmative, ANY for negative — applied to a new structure.

Examples: Negative in Context

Singular and plural negatives:

Looking for a store

There isn't a pet store on this street.

Checking the fridge

There aren't any eggs left.

At the mall

There isn't a bookstore here anymore.

In a small town

There aren't many restaurants in my village.

SECTION 4

Questions & Short Answers

Is there...? Are there...?

Is There / Are There: Questions

The Rule: flip IS/ARE and THERE

There is a bookstore. → IS THERE a bookstore?

IS THERE + singular noun

Is there a bookstore?

ARE THERE + any + plural noun

Are there any stores open?

Notice: plural questions also use ANY — "Are there ANY stores open?" not "Are there stores open?" (both technically work, but ANY sounds more natural in questions.)

Short Answers

Question	Short Yes	Short No
Is there a bookstore?	Yes, there is.	No, there isn't.

Are there any stores?

Yes, there are.

No, there aren't.

 *Same rule you already know: YES never contracts ("Yes, there is"), NO always contracts ("No, there isn't"). Just like "to be" and "do/does."*

Examples: Questions & Answers

Asking and answering about existence:

At a new city

Is there a subway here? — Yes, there is.

Checking options

Are there any vegetarian restaurants? — Yes, there are.

At the store

Is there a sale today? — No, there isn't.

Planning a trip

Are there any hotels nearby? — No, there aren't.

SECTION 5

When to Use Each

There Is/Are vs. To Be vs. Have — don't mix them up!

There Is/Are vs. To Be vs. Have

THERE IS/ARE

Introduces something for the first time — new information.

There is a store on this street.

TO BE

Describes a subject you already know — identity or state.

The store is big.

HAVE

Shows possession — what something owns or contains.

The store has many products.

💡 See how they connect: "There is a store on this street" (introducing it) → "The store is big" (describing it, now that we know it) → "The store has many products" (what it possesses).

There Is/Are vs. It Is / They're

The most common mix-up in this unit.

THERE IS/ARE

Announces something exists — usually the FIRST time you mention it.

"There's a bookstore on Elm Street."

IT IS / THEY'RE

Identifies something SPECIFIC — already mentioned, or right in front of you.

"What's that?" — "It's a bookstore."

⚠ The mistake to avoid

*X "It is two bookstores on Main Street." ✓ "There ARE two bookstores on Main Street."
Don't use IT IS with a plural noun — that's what THERE ARE is for.*

💡 Watch the natural hand-off in real conversation:

"There's a bookstore near my house. IT'S on Elm Street. IT'S small, but it HAS a lot of good books."

SECTION 6

Practice

Fill in the blank, choose the best response, and a live drill.

Practice: Fill in the Blank

Complete with There is / There are / Is there / Are there:

1. _____ a lot of stores in my city.

2. _____ a pet store near my house.

3. _____ a furniture store in her village.

4. _____ many students in the class today.

5. _____ a cat in the café?

6. _____ any nice stores near your apartment?

Fill in the Blank: Answers

1. There are a lot of stores in my city.

2. There is a pet store near my house.

3. There is a furniture store in her village.

4. There are many students in the class today.

5. Is there a cat in the café?

6. Are there any nice stores near your apartment?

Choose the Best Response

1. "Where are the books?"

- a) Here are the students.
- b) The teacher is in the class.
- c) The bookstore is open.
- d) There are some books on the table.

2. "Is there a bookstore nearby?"

- a) Yes, there is.
- b) It's closed.
- c) I like books.
- d) Two dollars.

3. "What's in the fridge?"

- a) There's some milk and cheese.
- b) I'm hungry.
- c) It's Monday.
- d) Yes, please.

4. "Are there any pet stores in this mall?"

- a) No, there aren't.
- b) I have a dog.
- c) It's expensive.
- d) Yes, I do.

Choose the Best Response: Answers

1. There are some books on the table.

2. Yes, there is.

3. There's some milk and cheese.

4. No, there aren't.

Quick Chat Drill

I ask, you type the answer in the chat:

1. Is there a supermarket in your city?

2. Are there many stores near your house?

3. Is there a bookstore in your neighborhood?

4. Are there any expensive stores near you?

SECTION 7

Notice It!

A real street — find every there is / there are.

Welcome to Elm Street!

Welcome to Elm Street! There are many stores here. There's a big supermarket on the corner — it's open every day. Next to it, there's a small bookstore. It's closed on Sundays.

Is there a shoe store on Elm Street? Yes, there is! It's next to the bookstore. There isn't a pet store on this street, but there's one on Main Street.

Are there any clothing stores here? Yes, there are two! They're both open until 8pm. There aren't any furniture stores on Elm Street — you need to go downtown for that.

Notice It!

Go back to the Elm Street passage and find:

1

How many times does "there is / there's" appear? Count them.

2

How many times does "there are" appear? Count them.

3

Find ONE negative sentence with "there isn't" or "there aren't."

4

Find TWO questions — one with "is there," one with "are there."

Notice It!: Answers

1. "There's/there is" appears 4 times: supermarket, bookstore, shoe store (answer), pet store (Main Street).

2. "There are" appears 2 times: "There are many stores," "there are two" (clothing stores).

3. Negative: "There isn't a pet store" / "There aren't any furniture stores."

4. Questions: "Is there a shoe store...?" and "Are there any clothing stores...?"

SECTION 8

Riddle Time!

Using everything from today — your way.

Riddle Model: What Is It?

1. It's big and strong.
2. It lives in Africa.
3. There's a long trunk on its face.
4. There are two big ears.
5. It eats plants, not meat.
6. It sleeps at night and eats in the morning.
7. It's gray.

Answer: It's an elephant!

Your Turn! Write Your Own Riddle

Choose ONE word below. Write 5-6 clues — don't say the word! Take 5 minutes.

Animals

elephant · dog · cat · lion · fish · bird

Countries

Panama · USA · Mexico · Spain · Canada · Brazil

Professions

teacher · doctor · waiter · nurse · chef · police officer

Use as many structures from today as you can: to be, present simple, there is/are, in/on/at.

Then: random picker chooses 4-6 students to read their clues — the class guesses in the chat!

Great job today!

There is / There are complete: affirmative, negative, questions — and you noticed it all in a real passage.

No homework, no Kahoot today.

Next class:

Shopping Vocabulary — closing out Unit 4

Unit 4 platform work due Saturday.